BOOKLET

Eurovision Song Contest 2026

Final

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About

When is Eurovision?

The Final will take place on May 16.

Before it:

- May 12 — First Semi-Final
- May 14 — Second Semi-Final

Who qualifies for the final?

This year, 35 countries are taking part. Five of them automatically qualify for the final:

- members of the Big Five: the United Kingdom, Germany, Italy, France and Spain (Spain is part of the Big Five, but is not participating this year)
- last year's winning country: Austria

We will see performances by these countries in the semi-finals, but since their place in the final is guaranteed, it will not be possible to vote for them.

The remaining 30 participating countries are split evenly between the two semi-finals. 10 of them will qualify for the final from each semi-final.

How does the voting work?

Voting at Eurovision consists of two parts:

- televote
- jury vote

Viewers in each participating country vote for the songs they like. The 10 most popular songs receive points on this scale:

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 **8** **10** **12**

The jury from each country gives votes using the same principle.

Then the televote points and jury points are added together.

The country with the most points wins.

Countries cannot vote for themselves.

In addition, viewers from countries that are not participating in the contest can also vote. Their votes are combined into one separate "country" called "Rest of the World".

What is the Big Five?

The Big Five are the United Kingdom, Germany, Italy, France and Spain. Because these countries make the largest financial contribution to the European Broadcasting Union, which helps fund the production of the show, they automatically qualify for the final.

How do countries choose their songs?

There are two main ways to choose a song:

- National selection, where a contest is held in the country and the winner becomes the country's representative
- Internal selection, where representatives of the national broadcaster / TV channel or a professional jury choose which entry to send as the country's representative

Austria

Eurovision host

Artist

Cosmó

Benjamin Gedeon

b. 2006

Budapest, Hungary

→ Halbturn, Austria

One of the youngest participants in this year's contest.

He reached the final of Germany's The Voice Kids in 2022, where he sang two Frank Sinatra songs.

Country

Bookies expect:

Win <1%

- 3× winner
- qualified for final 3× in a row

public selection

Austria won the contest last year, finishing first in the jury vote. This year, Austria is hosting Eurovision in Vienna.

Song

Tanzschein

Dance License

German

Dance-Pop

The idea for the song came when Cosmó went to a club and saw that nobody was dancing.

Tanzschein

Steh' vor dem Club (Ey), bin schon gespannt
Sag, hast du Lust auf einen Tanz?
Wir treten ein, mh, auf der Suche nach Ekstase
Doch hinterm Neonlichterschein liegt eine Tier-Oase
Und der Löwe versucht's bei einer Gazelle
Der Hunger macht ihn böse und er rückt ihr auf die Pelle
Im Gehege geht er durch wie eine Säge
Ist bekanntlich nicht romantisch, er steht nicht aufs Gerede

Ey, ey, das kann doch gar nicht wahr sein
Die machen sich zum Affen und Tänzer seh' ich gar kein'n
Ey, ey, ich hätt eine Idee, ein Konzept
Ja, das wär einfach perfekt

Sie brauchen einen Tanzschein, da muss ich streng sein
Weil ohne Tanzschein, lass ich Sie nicht rein
Hab'n Sie einen Tanzschein? Das soll kein Witz sein
Weil ohne Tanzschein, da komm'n Sie nicht rein

Ich schließ die Augen, dann bin ich Clubbesitzer
Und auf der schwarzen Liste steh'n die Steroidenspritzer
Und auch wenn sie nur bell'n und eigentlich gar nicht beißen
Das ist hier die Regel, Hunde müssen draußen bleiben

Ey, ey, so kann es jeden Tag sein
Wir tanzen durch die Nacht und Löwen seh' ich gar kein'n
Ey, ey, draußen macht sich wer zum Affen
Doch der Türsteher sagt mit einem Lachen

Sie brauchen einen Tanzschein, da muss ich streng sein
Weil ohne Tanzschein, lass ich Sie nicht rein
Hab'n Sie einen Tanzschein? Das soll kein Witz sein
Weil ohne Tanzschein, da komm'n Sie nicht rein

Der Gorilla in der Ecke träumt von seiner Pirouette
Er scheut sich vor den Blicken, die die Artgenossen schicken
Ich nehm ihn an der Hand, ja, bildet einen Gang
Wir schau'n uns in die Augen und jetzt fang'n wir an

Ey, ey, ey, ey, du kannst mir vertrau'n
Ey, ey, ey, ey, hier ist alles erlaubt
Oh, oh-oh, oh
Wir hab'n uns doch lang genug versteckt

Und alle wollen einen Tanzschein, sie wollen wie wir sein

Doch ohne Tanzschein werden sie Tiere bleiben
Hab'n Sie einen Tanzschein? Das soll kein Witz sein
Weil ohne Tanzschein, da komm'n Sie nicht rein

Dance License

I'm standing by the club (Ay), I'm already excited
Tell me, do you wanna dance?
We enter, mm, in search of ecstasy
But behind the neon lights there's an animal oasis
And the lion tries it on a gazelle
Hunger makes him angry, and he gets on her nerves
He cuts through the enclosure like a saw
He's known as non-romantic, and he also doesn't like the talk

Ay, ay, that can't be true
They act like monkeys, and I don't see any dancers

Ay, ay, I have an idea, a concept
Yeah, that'd be just perfect

You need a dance license, I have to be strict about that
'Cause without a dance license, I won't let you in
Do you have a dance license? This isn't a joke
'Cause without a dance license, you can't come in

I close my eyes, then I'm a club owner
And the steroid injectiors are blacklisted
And even if they just bark and don't actually bite

There's a rule that says that dogs must stay outside

Ay, ay, this can be like that every day
We're dancing through the night and I don't see any lions
Ay, ay, someone's acting like a monkey
But the bouncer says with a laugh

You need a dance license, I have to be strict about that
'Cause without a dance license, I won't let you in
Do you have a dance license? This isn't a joke
'Cause without a dance license, you can't come in

The gorilla in the corner is dreaming of his pirouette
He shies away from the looks that his kinsmen send

I'll take him by the hand, yes, let's have a walk
We'll look into each other's eyes and now let's get it started

Ay, ay, ay, ay, you can trust me
Ay, ay, ay, ay, everything's allowed here
Oh, oh-oh, oh
We've been hiding long enough

And everyone wants a dance license, they want to be like us

But without a dance license, they'll remain animals
Do you have a dance license? This isn't a joke
'Cause without a dance license, you can't come in

France

Big Five

Artist

Monroe

Monroe Vata Rigby

b. 2008

Salt Lake City, USA

The youngest participant this year.

Country

Bookies expect:

Win 14%

• 5× winner

internal selection

Song

Regarde !

Look!

French

Orchestral Pop

Classical Crossover

A distinctive feature of the song is its combination of operatic and pop vocals.

Regarde !	Look!
Quand tout s'illumine dans tout Paris Que les rues se vident, je reste ici	When everything lights up all across Paris And the streets fall silent, I stay here
J'ai cherché ton amour Dans tous les faubourgs Je chante tous les jours	I searched for your love In every neighborhood I sing every day
Regarde-moi, regarde-toi C'est ça l'amour, ça te foudroie	Look at me, look at yourself That's what love is, it strikes you like lightning
Regarde-moi, regarde-toi C'est ça l'amour, tu ne seras jamais perdu	Look at me, look at yourself That's what love is, you will never be lost
Allez, viens, je peux t'emmener Là où c'est fort, fort de s'aimer Allez, viens, tu n'es pas fou Dans ma poitrine, tu rythmes mon pouls Allez, viens, sous la pluie battante Je dirai aux gens qu'il est présent Je dirai aux femmes, aux hommes, aux enfants Je dirais au monde, dans chaque chanson	Come on, I can take you To a place where love burns strong, so strong Come on, you're not crazy In my chest, you set the rhythm of my pulse Come on, under the pouring rain I'll tell people that it's real I'll tell the women, the men, the children I'll tell the world, in every song
J'ai cherché ton amour Dans tous les faubourgs Je chante tous les jours	I searched for your love In every neighborhood I sing every day
Regarde-moi, regarde-toi C'est ça l'amour, ça te foudroie	Look at me, look at yourself That's what love is, it strikes you like lightning
Regarde-moi, regarde-toi C'est ça l'amour, tu ne seras jamais perdu	Look at me, look at yourself That's what love is, you will never be lost
C'est ça l'amour, chut Il est partout, chut Il est là, là, là	That's what love is, hush It's everywhere, hush It is there, there, there
Regarde-moi, regarde-toi C'est ça l'amour, ça te foudroie	Look at me, look at yourself That's what love is, it strikes you like lightning
Regarde-moi	Look at me

Official video • Live

Germany

Big Five

Artist

Sarah Engels

b. 1992

Cologne

She became known in 2011 after finishing second on Deutschland sucht den Superstar.

Later, she also finished second on Let’s Dance and won Das große Promibacken, The Masked Singer and Dancing on Ice.

She has released six studio albums and more than 30 singles.

Country

Bookies expect:

Win <1%

• 2× winner

public selection

Song

Fire

English

Power pop

Fire

Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

Boy, I'm out of your league
Nonsense what you've been doin' to me
Just know that I could take my revenge
I could go out with all of your friends

I can fake it 'til I make it, but I won't (Fake it 'til I make it, but I won't)
If you crave it, you can take it, but you don't (Crave it, you can take it, but you don't)
I don't want it, I don't need it, and I won't let you repeat it
You just play it 'til you break it and it's blown

I'm on fire, fire, you're a liar, liar
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more
Like a vampire, you hide, then come out the night
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

I'm on fire, fire
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

Just wait a minute, you're gonna see
That you won't find another like me
You'll come around and I'll be to late
'Cause I won't do the same old mistake

I can fake it 'til I make it, but I won't (Fake it 'til I make it, but I won't)
If you crave it, you can take it, but you don't (Crave it, you can take it, but you don't)
I don't want it, I don't need it, and I won't let you repeat it
You just play it 'til you break it and it's blown

I'm on fire, fire, you're a liar, liar
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more
Like a vampire, you hide, then come out the night
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

I'm on fire, fire
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more
Like a vampire, you hide, then come out the night
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

I'm on fire

I'm on fire, fire, you're a liar, liar
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more
Like a vampire, you hide, then come out the night
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

I'm on fire
I'm on fire
Like a vampire, you hide, then come out the night
Stop denyin', -nyin', no lyin', lyin' no more

National selection • Official video

Italy

Big Five

Artist

Sal Da Vinci

Salvatore Sorrentino

b. 1969

New York City, USA

→ Naples, Italy

The oldest participant this year.

Son of Mario Da Vinci, a classical Neapolitan singer.

He has released 25 studio albums, 9 of them together with his father.

Country

Bookies expect:

Win 3.4%

• 3× winner

public selection

The last time Italy failed to reach the top 7 was in 2016.

Song

Per sempre sì

Forever Yes

Italian Neapolitan

Disco funk

Canzone napoletana

Per sempre sì

È cominciato tutto quanto dal principio
Io che per te ero solo un uomo sconosciuto
Poi diventato un re dal cuore innamorato
Tu una regina, ora vestita in bianco sposa
Abbiamo sognato figli in una grande casa
E superato tutte le difficoltà
Perché un amore non è amore per la vita
Se non ha affrontato la più ripida salita

E si accenderà la musica e qui ti aspetterò

Il più grande giorno ti regalerò

Saremo io e te per sempre
Legati per la vita che
Senza te non vale niente
Non ha senso vivere
Con la mano sul petto
Io te lo prometto davanti a Dio
Saremo io e te da qui
Sarà per sempre "sì"

So bene che è una grande incognita il futuro
Ma insieme a te non mi spaventerà perché
Costruiremo tutto, ma non alzeremo un muro
Litigare e far l'amore e poi che male c'è?

E si accenderà la musica, per te io canterò
Il più grande giorno ti regalerò

Saremo io e te per sempre
Legati per la vita che
Senza te non vale niente
Non ha senso vivere
Con la mano sul petto
Io te lo prometto davanti a Dio
Saremo io e te da qui
Sarà per sempre "sì"

Soltanto "sì"
Per questi giorni e mille altri ancora
Un semplice "sì"
L'eternità è dentro una parola

Saremo io e te per sempre
Legati per la vita che
Senza te non vale niente
Non ha senso vivere
Con la mano sul petto
Io te lo prometto davanti a Dio
Saremo io e te accussí
Sarrà pe sempe "sì"

Forever Yes

It all started right from the beginning
I, who was just an unknown man to you
Then became a king with a heart in love
You a queen, now dressed in white as a bride
We dreamed of children in a big house
And overcame all the difficulties
Because a love isn't a love for life
If it hasn't faced the steepest climb

And the music will start playing and I will wait for you here
I will give you the greatest day

It will be you and me forever
Tied for this life that
Without you is worth nothing
Makes no sense to live
With my hand on my chest
I promise you before God
It will be you and me
From here on, it will forever be "Yes"

I know well that the future is a great unknown
But together with you, it won't scare me because
We will build everything, but we won't raise a wall
Fighting and making love, and then what's wrong with that?

And the music will start playing, I will sing for you
I will give you the greatest day

It will be you and me forever
Tied for this life that
Without you is worth nothing
Makes no sense to live
With my hand on my chest
I promise you before God
It will be you and me
From here on, it will forever be "Yes"

Only "Yes"
For these days and a thousand more
A simple "Yes"
Eternity is inside one word

It will be you and me forever
Tied for this life that
Without you is worth nothing
Makes no sense to live
With my hand on my chest
I promise you before God
It will be you and me
And so it will forever be "Yes"

United Kingdom

Big Five

Artist

Look Mum No Computer

Sam Battle

b. 1989

Grantham

He has been running a YouTube blog with musical experiments for many years.

Country

Bookies expect:

Win <1%

• 5× winner

internal selection

In the United Kingdom, the contest has a large fan base, but the country's songs are rarely popular. The phrase "0 points to the United Kingdom" has become a meme.

Song

Eins, Zwei, Drei

English German

Synth-pop

For Bulgaria, the United Kingdom, and Switzerland, the staging and choreography are directed by Fredrik Rydman, who previously directed Sweden in 2015 ("Heroes", 1st place), Finland in 2023 ("Cha Cha Cha", 2nd place), and Switzerland in 2024 ("The Code", 1st place).

Eins, Zwei, Drei

So sick of doing the whole 9 to 5
I pay my dues, I'm just stayin' alive
And I'm so bored of it, bored of it
Oh, what's the point of it, point of it? (Oh, ja, ja, ja)
A paracetamol to quench the pain
The office cubicle has trapped me again
Am I a mouse in a cage, am I
D-d-d-demotivational?

Ah, if only there was a language
That I could count in
That would make me feel better (Oh, ja)

Eins, zwei, drei
Darlin', I need something salty
Eins, zwei, drei
With a slice of pepperoni
I'll pay, you can owe me
That'll be a pony
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life
Eins, zwei, drei
Got me feeling okey-dokey
Eins, zwei, drei
Goodbye drudgery, hello me
So light you can throw me
Kill at karaoke
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm coming back to life

Countin' in English doesn't cut the mustard
So sick of munching roly-poly with custard
I'm so bored with it, bored with it
Oh, what's the point of it, point of it? (Oh, ja, ja, ja)
I've always been a fan of aviation
I'm jumpin' on a plane to another nation
And all my pounds, they feel counterfeit
I need some euros to counter it

Eins, zwei, drei
Darlin', I need something salty
Eins, zwei, drei
With a slice of pepperoni
I'll pay, you can owe me
That'll be a pony
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life
Eins, zwei, drei
Got me feeling okey-dokey
Eins, zwei, drei
Goodbye drudgery, hello me
So light you can throw me
Kill at karaoke
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life

Eins
Zwei
Drei
Eins, zwei
Eins, zwei, drei

Eins, zwei, drei
Darlin', I need something salty
Eins, zwei, drei
With a slice of pepperoni
I'll pay, you can owe me
That'll be a pony
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life
Eins, zwei, drei
Darlin', I need something salty
Eins, zwei, drei
With a slice of pepperoni
I'll pay, you can owe me
That'll be a pony
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life

Eins, zwei, drei
Eins, zwei, drei
I'm comin' back to life

Official video • Live